Seagate Public Aquarium

1 Pier Approach, Marrow Bay, MB6 2LN | www.seagateaquarium-example.org

Aquarium Biologist (Entry Level)

Reference: REF: SPA-BIO-2026-007

Location:	Seagate Public Aquarium, Marrow Bay (on-site)
Department:	Husbandry & Life Support
Reports to:	Senior Aquarist
Contract:	Permanent, Full-time (40 hrs/week, rota incl. weekends & bank holidays)
Salary:	£23,400 – £25,100 per annum
Start date:	October 2026

About Us

Seagate Public Aquarium is a small independent aquarium housing around 120 marine and freshwater species across 34 display and quarantine systems, including a 380,000-litre temperate ocean display, a coral reef exhibit and a native species touch pool. We are accredited members of the regional zoo and aquarium association and run active breeding programmes for seahorses and native rays.

The Role

This is an entry-level position ideal for a recent graduate or career-changer looking to start a career in aquatic animal husbandry. A significant, hands-on part of the role is the routine maintenance of our life support systems (LSS) — you will be cleaning filters, backwashing sand filters, changing filter socks and floss, and scrubbing sumps and protein skimmers on a daily rota. Alongside this you will support feeding, water quality testing and general exhibit care under the supervision of senior staff. Full training will be provided.

Key Responsibilities

- Clean and maintain filtration systems: backwash sand filters, replace filter socks/floss, clean cartridge and canister filters, and scrub sumps and pipework on the daily LSS rota
- Clean and maintain protein skimmers, UV sterilisers and pump strainer baskets; report faults to the Senior Aquarist
- Carry out daily water quality testing (salinity, temperature, pH, ammonia, nitrite, nitrate) and log results
- Prepare diets and feed fish and invertebrates according to established feeding schedules
- Clean exhibit windows, decor and surrounding public areas to presentation standard
- Assist with animal health checks, quarantine procedures and record-keeping in the animal management database
- Support exhibit moves, animal acquisitions and breeding programme tasks as directed
- Engage with visitors during feeding talks and behind-the-scenes tours (training provided)

Essential Requirements

- A degree in Marine Biology, Zoology, Aquatic Biology or a related life science (or equivalent practical experience)

- Genuine willingness to carry out physical, dirty and repetitive tasks — filter cleaning and LSS maintenance form a core part of this role
- Basic understanding of water chemistry and the nitrogen cycle in closed aquatic systems
- Strong observational skills and attention to detail, with careful record-keeping habits
- Physically fit: able to lift up to 25 kg, work on ladders, and work in warm, humid back-of-house environments
- Able to work weekends, bank holidays and occasional early mornings on a rota basis
- Full right to work in the UK and ability to pass a basic background check

Desirable (Not Essential)

- SCUBA certification (or willingness to train towards one in the first year)
- Home aquarium keeping experience or prior volunteer work at an aquarium, zoo or animal facility
- Familiarity with life support system components (sand filters, protein skimmers, ozone, UV)
- Full clean driving licence

What We Offer

- 22 days annual leave plus bank holidays (rota-adjusted)
- Employer pension contribution of 5%
- Paid SCUBA training and dive physical for the right candidate
- Free aquarium entry for family and friends
- Structured progression pathway toward Aquarist grade within 18–24 months

How to Apply

Email your CV and a covering letter (max 1 page) telling us why you want to work hands-on with aquatic life support systems to jobs@seagateaquarium-example.org, quoting reference SPA-BIO-2026-007. Shortlisted candidates will be invited to a working interview, which includes a practical filter-cleaning and water-testing task, plus a short panel interview.

Closing date: Friday 11 September 2026, 17:00

SYNTHETIC SAMPLE DOCUMENT — created for CV-screening software testing only. This organisation, vacancy and contact details are fictional.